

AST1410 (Winter 2026) MESA Practical 1

Due 11:59pm 1 Feb 2026

Practicals must be submitted to essick@cita.utoronto.ca before the deadline.

Practicals should be submitted as a PDF describing your results.

Your PDF must be accompanied by a plain ASCII file with all scripts, etc that you developed or a link to a public github repository. If you choose to submit as a github repository, you must specify which commit/hash and branch you are submitting.

Part 1 (0 points)

Install MESA on the computer of your choice. The following instructions may be helpful:

- <https://docs.mesastar.org/en/latest/installation.html#installing-mesa>

Note, you do not have to include proof that you did this within your submission.

Part 2 (5 points)

Run a stellar model. You should follow this tutorial

- https://docs.mesastar.org/en/latest/using_mesa/running.html

and reproduce the $\log(L) - \log(T)$ version of the HR diagram.